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CAUSE-EFFECT PARAGRAPHS

The first cause of the aging population is the decrease in the birth rate. In Singapore, for example, the country experienced one of the lowest fertility rates at just 0.83 children per woman in 2017 (Hirschmann, 2020). Similarly, the "one-child policy" in China led to a significant reduction in fertility rates, contributing to the aging population trend. The next reason is increased life expectancy. Factors such as improved living conditions and a better medical system have all played a role in increasing life expectancy. Singapore's medical system, for example, has been recognized as one of the best in the world. According to Hirschmann (2020), with more people living longer and healthier, it was predicted that people aged 65 and above will account for 32% of the Singapore population by 2035.

One effect of the aging population is changes in the labor market. It is expected that the ratio of the population over sixty years old will reach 30 percent in 2040 in China (Textor, 2020). In Singapore, the proportion of elderly citizens is expected to increase significantly by 2035. Many elderly Singaporeans feel they are not prepared financially to retire, and thus they may still be employed in their twilight year, leading to an increase in seniors in the Singapore workforce (Hirschmann, 2020). Furthermore, such changes in the labor market influenced the economic structure. For instance, China’s labor force shrank for the first time in decades in 2015; consequently, the government is trying to transform the economic structure from labor-intensive to value-creating (Textor, 2020). A further effect is a higher demand for the government pension and medical system. Older people frequently require financial support. Correspondingly, the Singapore government introduced the Pioneer and Merdeka Generation Package to support senior citizens (Hirschmann, 2020). Likewise, in China, this demographic shift has put a strain on the public pension system and necessitates government efforts to support those who pensions are inadequate compared to the rising cost of living (Textor, 2020).

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